

Deployment Checklist

Use this checklist to ensure everything is set up correctly.

Before Deployment

Database

- ☐ I have my PostgreSQL DATABASE_URL ready
- ☐ The database is accessible from external IPs
- ☐ The connection string format is correct: `postgresql://username:password@hostname:5432/database_name`

SMTP (Gmail)

- ☐ I have a Gmail account
- ☐ 2-Step Verification is enabled
- ☐ I've generated an App Password
- ☐ I've copied the 16-character app password

GitHub

- ☐ I have a GitHub account
- ☐ I've created a new repository for this service
- ☐ Git is installed on my computer

Railway

- ☐ I've signed up at railway.app
 - ☐ I've connected my GitHub account to Railway
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During Deployment

Code Upload

- ☐ I've initialized git in the `ride-alert-monitor` folder
- ☐ I've committed all files
- ☐ I've pushed to my GitHub repository

Railway Setup

- ☐ I've created a new Railway project
- ☐ I've connected it to my GitHub repo
- ☐ Railway detected it as a Node.js app
- ☐ The build completed successfully

Environment Variables

- ☐ Added `DATABASE_URL`

- ☐ Added `SMTP_HOST` (smtp.gmail.com)
 - ☐ Added `SMTP_PORT` (587)
 - ☐ Added `SMTP_USER` (my Gmail address)
 - ☐ Added `SMTP_PASS` (my 16-char app password)
 - ☐ Added `SMTP_FROM` ("Orlando Insider" my-email@gmail.com)
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Post-Deployment

Verification

- ☐ Service is running (not crashed)
- ☐ Logs show "SMTP connection verified"
- ☐ Logs show "Checking alerts every 2 minutes"
- ☐ No error messages in logs
- ☐ First monitoring cycle completed successfully

Testing

- ☐ Created a test ride alert on my website
- ☐ Monitoring service detected the alert
- ☐ Notification was sent successfully (check logs)
- ☐ Received SMS notification

Monitoring

- ☐ Added Railway project to bookmarks
 - ☐ Know how to access logs (Logs tab in Railway)
 - ☐ Understand the log format
 - ☐ Can see heartbeat messages every 10 minutes
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Success Criteria

Your deployment is successful if:

- ☒ Railway dashboard shows service is "RUNNING"
 - ☒ Logs show monitoring cycles every 2 minutes
 - ☒ Logs show heartbeat every 10 minutes
 - ☒ No error messages in logs
 - ☒ Test alert triggered a notification
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Maintenance

Weekly

- ☐ Check Railway logs for any errors
- ☐ Verify service is still running
- ☐ Check that notifications are being sent

Monthly

- [] Review Railway usage (should stay in free tier)
 - [] Verify SMTP connection is still working
 - [] Check database connection is healthy
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Common Issues

Issue: Service keeps restarting

Solution: Check logs for error, verify DATABASE_URL

Issue: No notifications being sent

Solution: Verify SMTP credentials, check user has SMS email configured

Issue: “SMTP connection failed”

Solution: Regenerate Gmail app password, update SMTP_PASS

Issue: “Database connection error”

Solution: Whitelist Railway IP, verify DATABASE_URL format

All done? Your monitoring service is bulletproof! 🎉